The Tengger Volcanic Complex

An unearthly looking group of volcanic cones inside an ancient caldera, all set within lush tropical vegetation

The Tengger Volcanic Complex is part of a national park on the Indonesian island of Java. The complex lies within a large caldera, the remains of an enormous volcano that disintegrated in a cataclysmic eruption over 45,000 years ago. Over the past few thousand years, several new volcanic cones have grown from its floor. Of these, the most easily recognized—because its top has been blown off, leaving a wide summit crater—is Mount Bromo.

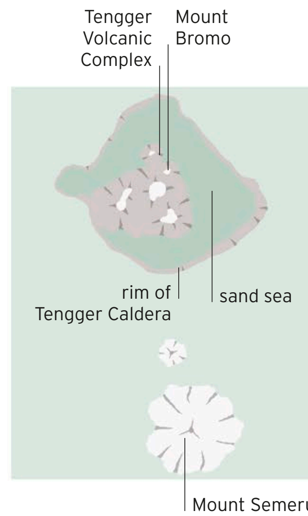
Recent eruptions

Mount Bromo is the youngest, most active, and most frequently visited of the volcanoes. It has erupted repeatedly since 1590. Outside the caldera is a larger volcano, Semeru, which also regularly belches out huge clouds of steam and smoke. At 12,060 ft (3,676 m), Semeru is Java's highest mountain.

△ TENGGER PANORAMA
In this view, the volcanic cones comprising the Tengger Complex can be seen at the center, with smoke emanating from Mount Bromo. In the distance is Mount Semeru.

TENGGER AND SEMERU

The Tengger Caldera is roughly square in shape. Its flat, sand-filled floor is called the Sand Sea. Within the caldera are five overlapping stratovolcanoes. A few kilometers to the south is the large active stratovolcano Semeru.



▽ DAWN PERSPECTIVE
Here, part of the Tengger Caldera's rim is visible, with a hamlet–a base for exploring the complex–perched on it. On the right is the mist-covered caldera.

The **caldera** within which **the Tengger complex** sits is **10 miles (16 km)** wide